

23.5 Freedman–Lane and related schemes

With a continuous nuisance regressor in Eq. 23.4.2, no permutation of the responses leaves the null distribution unchanged. Several schemes permute something else, or permute the responses and hope. None is exact in general, but their differences can be understood with the projection algebra of [Chapter 6](#).

23.5.1 Five schemes

Keep the notation of Eq. 23.4.2: $\mathbf{Z}$ is $n \times p_0$ with $\mathbf{1} \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$, $\mathbf{X}_1$ is $n \times q$, the full model matrix $[\mathbf{Z}, \mathbf{X}_1]$ has rank $p = p_0 + q < n$, $\mathbf{M}_0$ projects onto $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$ and $\mathbf{M}$ onto $\mathcal{C}([\mathbf{Z}, \mathbf{X}_1])$. The statistic for $H_0: \beta_1 = \mathbf{0}$ is the F statistic of Theorem 11.1.1, written as a function of the response vector:

$$F(\mathbf{u}) = \frac{\|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{u}\|^2/q}{\|(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{u}\|^2/(n-p)}. \quad (23.5.1)$$

Since $(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{0}$ and $(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{0}$, $F(\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{Z}\mathbf{g}) = F(\mathbf{u})$ for every $\mathbf{g}$. Let

$$\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0 = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{y}, \quad \hat{\mathbf{e}} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{y}$$

be the residuals of the reduced and the full model. By Theorem 6.6.2, $\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0$ projects onto $\mathcal{C}(\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_1)$ with $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_1 = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{X}_1$.

Definition 23.5.1. Permutation schemes for a partial hypothesis

For a permutation matrix $\mathbf{P}$, each scheme computes a permuted statistic; its p-value is Eq. 23.4.1 with $T(\mathbf{y})$ the observed $F(\mathbf{y})$ and $T(\mathbf{P}_b\mathbf{y})$ replaced by the scheme's permuted statistic.

- (a) **Raw permutation** (Manly 1997): $F(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{y})$, refitting the full model to permuted responses.
- (b) **Permuting the regressors of interest** (Draper and Stoneman 1966): the F statistic computed from $\mathbf{y}$ with model matrix $[\mathbf{Z}, \mathbf{P}\mathbf{X}_1]$.
- (c) **Kennedy's scheme** (Kennedy 1995): regress $\mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0$ on $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_1$ alone and compute $F_K(\mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0)$, where $F_K(\mathbf{u}) = \frac{\|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{u}\|^2/q}{(\|\mathbf{u}\|^2 - \|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{u}\|^2)/(n-p)}$.
- (d) **Freedman–Lane** (Freedman and Lane 1983): form $\mathbf{y}^* = \mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{y} + \mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0$, the reduced-model fit plus permuted reduced-model residuals, and compute $F(\mathbf{y}^*)$.
- (e) **ter Braak's scheme** (ter Braak 1992): form $\mathbf{y}^* = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{y} + \mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}$, the full-model fit plus permuted full-model residuals, and compute the F statistic for the hypothesis $\beta_1 = \hat{\beta}_1$, which is true in the permuted world.

23.5.2 What can be proved

Proposition 23.5.1. The Freedman–Lane scheme

In the setting above:

- (a) $F(\mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{y} + \mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0) = F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0)$ for every $\mathbf{P}$, and $F(\mathbf{y}) = F(\hat{\mathbf{e}}_0)$. ter Braak's permuted statistic equals $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\mathbf{e}})$.

- (b) Under H_0 , $\hat{\epsilon}_0 = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\epsilon$. The p-values of the Freedman–Lane, ter Braak, Kennedy and Draper–Stoneman schemes depend on $\mathbf{y}$ only through $(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{y}$, so under H_0 their distributions do not depend on γ . The raw permutation statistic involves γ .
- (c) Under H_0 , if $\mathbf{PZ} = \mathbf{Z}$ for every $\mathbf{P}$ in a group $\mathcal{G}$ and ϵ is $\mathcal{G}$ -invariant in distribution, then the Freedman–Lane test over $\mathcal{G}$ is exact, and it coincides with the raw permutation test over $\mathcal{G}$.
- (d) Suppose the errors are independent draws from one law with mean zero and variance $\sigma^2 > 0$, $\mathbf{P}$ is uniform over all permutations and independent of ϵ , and p is fixed as $n \rightarrow \infty$. Then under H_0 , $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}_0) - F(\mathbf{P}\epsilon) \rightarrow 0$ in probability, and so does $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}) - F(\mathbf{P}\epsilon)$.

Proof.

- (a) $\mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{y} \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$, so the invariance of [Eq. 23.5.1](#) gives the first claim, and $\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{y} + \hat{\epsilon}_0$ gives the second. In ter Braak's scheme, the F statistic for $\beta_1 = \hat{\beta}_1$ computed from $\mathbf{y}^*$ is the F statistic for $\beta_1 = \mathbf{0}$ computed from $\mathbf{y}^* - \mathbf{X}_1\hat{\beta}_1$, whose reduced model is the set of means $\mathbf{X}_1\hat{\beta}_1 + \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$: the numerators agree by Theorem 11.3.2(b), and the denominators agree because subtracting $\mathbf{X}_1\hat{\beta}_1 \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{X})$ leaves the residuals unchanged. Since $\mathbf{y}^* - \mathbf{X}_1\hat{\beta}_1 = \mathbf{Z}\hat{\gamma} + \mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}$ with $\mathbf{Z}\hat{\gamma} \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$, the statistic is $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon})$.
- (b) Under H_0 , $(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{y} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\epsilon$. Freedman–Lane and Kennedy use $\mathbf{y}$ only through $\hat{\epsilon}_0$, and ter Braak through $\hat{\epsilon} = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\hat{\epsilon}_0$. The Draper–Stoneman statistic is unchanged when a vector in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$ is added to $\mathbf{y}$. In each case the observed statistic is $F(\mathbf{y}) = F(\hat{\epsilon}_0)$ by (a). The raw permutation statistic $F(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{y}) = F(\mathbf{PZ}\gamma + \mathbf{P}\epsilon)$ involves γ whenever $\mathbf{PZ}\gamma \notin \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$, and its null distribution in general depends on γ , as [Figure 23.5.1](#) shows; we do not prove this.
- (c) $\mathbf{PZ} = \mathbf{Z}$ implies $\mathbf{PM}_0\mathbf{P}^\top = \mathbf{M}_0$, since $\mathbf{PM}_0\mathbf{P}^\top$ is the orthogonal projection onto $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{PZ}) = \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{Z})$. So $\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}_0 = \mathbf{P}(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\epsilon = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{P}\epsilon$ under H_0 , and $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}_0) = F(\mathbf{P}\epsilon)$ by invariance. Also $F(\mathbf{y}) = F(\epsilon)$. So the Freedman–Lane p-value is the permutation p-value of the statistic F applied to ϵ , which is exact by Theorem 23.4.2. The raw permutation statistic is $F(\mathbf{Z}\gamma + \mathbf{P}\epsilon) = F(\mathbf{P}\epsilon)$ as well.
- (d) Put $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{M}_0\epsilon$, so $\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}_0 = \mathbf{P}\epsilon - \mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}$. For a fixed vector $\mathbf{v}$ and a uniform random permutation, $E(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}) = \bar{v}\mathbf{1}$ and $\text{Cov}(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}) = \frac{S_v}{n-1}(\mathbf{I} - n^{-1}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top)$, where $S_v = \sum_i (v_i - \bar{v})^2 \leq \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$ ([Exercise \(B1\)](#)). Since $(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{1} = \mathbf{0}$,

$$\begin{aligned} E[\|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}\|^2 \mid \epsilon] &= \frac{S_v}{n-1} \text{tr}(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0) \\ &\leq \frac{q \|\mathbf{M}_0\epsilon\|^2}{n-1}, \end{aligned}$$

and $E\|\mathbf{M}_0\epsilon\|^2 = \sigma^2 p_0$, so $\|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}\| \rightarrow 0$ in probability. The numerators of the two statistics are $\|\mathbf{N}\|^2/q$ and $\|\mathbf{N} - \delta\|^2/q$ with $\mathbf{N} = (\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{P}\epsilon$ and $\delta = (\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}$. Here $\mathbf{P}\epsilon$ has the distribution of ϵ , so $E\|\mathbf{N}\|^2 = q\sigma^2$, and $|\|\mathbf{N} - \delta\|^2 - \|\mathbf{N}\|^2| \leq 2\|\mathbf{N}\|\|\delta\| + \|\delta\|^2 \rightarrow 0$ in probability. For the denominators, $|\|(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon}_0\| - \|(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{P}\epsilon\|| \leq \|\mathbf{v}\| = O_p(1)$, while $\|(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{P}\epsilon\|^2/(n-p)$ has the distribution of s^2 and tends to σ^2 in probability (Corollary 5.6.4 needs fourth moments; the argument of Lemma 23.1.3 needs only the second). Both norms are $O_p(\sqrt{n})$, so the difference of their squares is at most $\|\mathbf{v}\|$ times $O_p(\sqrt{n})$. Dividing by $n-p$, the two denominators differ by a quantity that tends to zero, and both tend to σ^2 . The claim for $F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\epsilon})$ is the same argument with $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{M}\epsilon$, $E\|\mathbf{M}\epsilon\|^2 = \sigma^2 p$.

■

Part (d) compares Freedman–Lane with an **oracle** that permutes the true errors. The oracle is exact: $F(\mathbf{y}) = F(\boldsymbol{\varepsilon})$ under H_0 , and it compares $F(\boldsymbol{\varepsilon})$ with $F(\mathbf{P}_b \boldsymbol{\varepsilon})$, a permutation test for the exchangeable $\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}$. Freedman–Lane replaces $\mathbf{P}_b \boldsymbol{\varepsilon}$ by $\mathbf{P}_b \hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0$, which changes the statistics by vanishing amounts. To conclude that its size tends to α , one needs also that the oracle statistics have a continuous joint limit, so that vanishing perturbations rarely change their ranks. That holds under conditions like Eq. 23.1.1 by a permutation central limit theorem that we do not prove; Anderson and Robinson (2001) give the argument.

Part (b) is the practical point: four of the schemes see the data only after $\mathbf{Z}$ has been projected out, while for large $\mathbf{Z}\boldsymbol{\gamma}$ the raw permutation mostly permutes $\mathbf{Z}\boldsymbol{\gamma}$, not the errors. Kennedy’s scheme can be pinned down exactly.

Proposition 23.5.2. Kennedy’s scheme is anticonservative relative to Freedman–Lane

For every permutation $\mathbf{P}$, $F_K(\mathbf{P}\hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0) \leq F(\mathbf{P}\hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0)$, with equality when $\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{I}$. Consequently, for any set of permutations $\mathbf{P}_1, \dots, \mathbf{P}_B$, the Kennedy p-value is at most the Freedman–Lane p-value.

Proof. The two statistics have the same numerator. Write $\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{P}\hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0$. Since $\mathbf{I} = \mathbf{M}_0 + (\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0) + (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})$ with orthogonal ranges,

$$\begin{aligned} \|(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{M})\mathbf{u}\|^2 &= \|\mathbf{u}\|^2 - \|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{u}\|^2 - \|\mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{u}\|^2 \\ &\leq \|\mathbf{u}\|^2 - \|(\mathbf{M} - \mathbf{M}_0)\mathbf{u}\|^2, \end{aligned}$$

so Kennedy’s denominator is at least as large. For $\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{I}$, $\mathbf{M}_0\hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0 = \mathbf{0}$, and the two agree. Each permuted Kennedy statistic is therefore at most the corresponding Freedman–Lane one, while the observed statistics coincide, so fewer permuted values reach the observed one. ■

The discrepancy $\|\mathbf{M}_0\mathbf{P}\hat{\boldsymbol{\varepsilon}}_0\|^2$, the part of the permuted residuals that $\mathbf{Z}$ could have explained, has expectation about $(p_0 - 1)\sigma^2$, small beside $(n - p)\sigma^2$ for large n ; so Kennedy’s scheme is liberal only in small samples.

23.5.3 Stack loss again, and a simulation

Example. Acid concentration given air flow and water temperature

In the full stack loss regression, test whether acid concentration matters once air flow and water temperature are in the model. The F statistic is 0.947 on 1 and 17 degrees of freedom, with p-value 0.344. With 19999 permutations each, the schemes give: raw permutation 0.346, Draper–Stoneman 0.343, Kennedy 0.315, Freedman–Lane 0.345 and ter Braak 0.345. Only Kennedy’s differs noticeably, in the direction [Proposition 23.5.2](#) predicts. The marginal association of Example (Acid concentration and stack loss) disappears once the correlated regressors are in the model.

```
import numpy as np
import statsmodels.api as sm
from scipy import stats
data = sm.datasets.stackloss.load_pandas().data
```

```

def proj(Z):
    """Orthogonal projection onto  $C(Z)$ , from a QR factorization."""
    Q, _ = np.linalg.qr(Z)
    return Q @ Q.T

def perm_rows(v, B, rng):
    """B random permutations of the vector v, one per row."""
    return v[np.argsort(rng.random((B, len(v))), axis=1)]

def perm_pvalues(y, x, Z, B, rng):
    """p-values for  $H_0: \beta = 0$  in  $E(y) = Z \gamma + x \beta$ , by six methods."""
    n, p = len(y), Z.shape[1] + 1
    MZ = proj(Z)
    xt = x - MZ @ x                    # x residualized on Z
    yt = y - MZ @ y                    # reduced-model residuals
    e_full = yt - xt * (xt @ yt) / (xt @ xt)  # full-model residuals (FWL)

    def F(Y):
        """F statistic for  $\beta = 0$ , for each row of Y (model matrix [Z, x] fixed)."""
        num = (Y @ xt) ** 2 / (xt @ xt)
        rss_Z = np.sum(Y ** 2, axis=-1) - np.sum((Y @ MZ) * Y, axis=-1)
        return num / ((rss_Z - num) / (n - p))

    F_obs = F(y)
    out = {"F test": stats.f.sf(F_obs, 1, n - p)}

    def pval(F_star, F0=F_obs):
        return (1 + np.sum(F_star >= F0)) / (len(F_star) + 1)

    out["Manly"] = pval(F(perm_rows(y, B, rng)))          # permute y
    Xs = perm_rows(x, B, rng)                             # permute x (
    Draper-Stoneman)
    xts = Xs - Xs @ MZ
    num = (xts @ y) ** 2 / np.sum(xts ** 2, axis=1)
    out["Draper-Stoneman"] = pval(num / ((yt @ yt - num) / (n - p)))
    Yk = perm_rows(yt, B, rng)                             # Kennedy: no Z
    in the refit
    num = (Yk @ xt) ** 2 / (xt @ xt)
    out["Kennedy"] = pval(num / ((np.sum(Yk ** 2, axis=1) - num) / (n - p)))
    out["Freedman-Lane"] = pval(F(perm_rows(yt, B, rng)))  # permute
    reduced residuals
    out["ter Braak"] = pval(F(perm_rows(e_full, B, rng)))  # permute full
    residuals
    return out, F_obs

rng = np.random.default_rng(2307)
y = data["STACKLOSS"].to_numpy()
x = data["ACIDCONC"].to_numpy()
Z = np.column_stack([np.ones(len(y)), data[["AIRFLOW", "WATERTEMP"]]])
pvals, F_obs = perm_pvalues(y, x, Z, B=19_999, rng=rng)
print(f"F = {F_obs:.3f}")
for m, pv in pvals.items():
    print(f"{m:16s} p = {pv:.4f}")

```

[Run this code online](#)

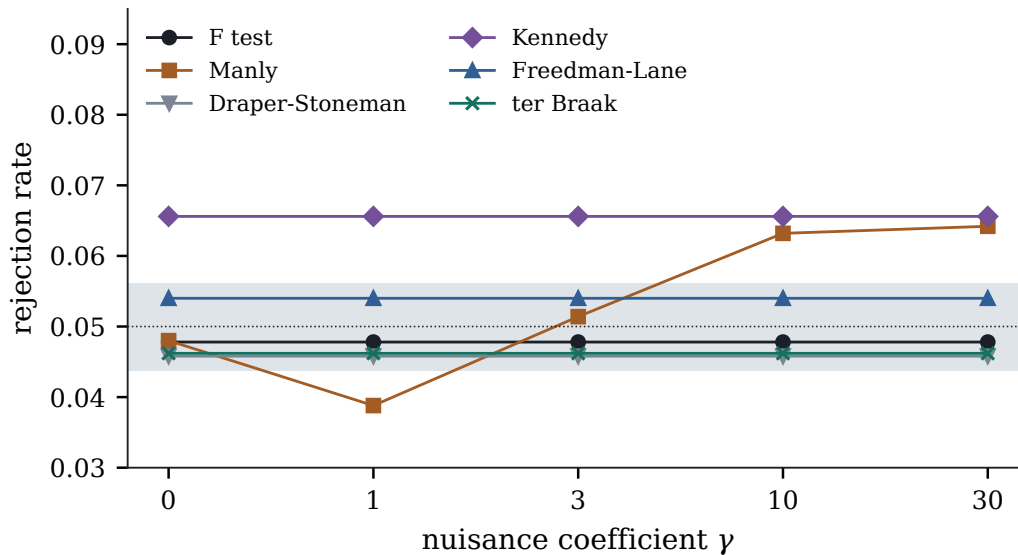


Figure 23.5.1: Null rejection rates of nominal 5% tests of one coefficient, $n = 12$, against the nuisance coefficient γ . The band is two Monte Carlo standard errors around 0.05.

Real data with a p-value near 0.34 cannot separate the schemes. The simulation in Figure 23.5.1 is designed to. It has $n = 12$ cases, normal errors, a nuisance regressor z correlated with the regressor of interest x , and one high-leverage value of x . The null hypothesis holds, and the nuisance coefficient γ ranges from 0 to 30. Each point is the rejection rate of a nominal 5% test in 5000 data sets, with 199 permutations each, so the Monte Carlo standard error is about 0.0031.

The same random numbers are used for every γ , so by Proposition 23.5.1(b) five of the six tests make identical decisions at every γ , and their lines are flat. The F test rejects in 0.048 of the data sets, Freedman–Lane in 0.054, ter Braak and Draper–Stoneman in 0.046, and Kennedy in 0.066, the liberal bias of Proposition 23.5.2 made visible by the small sample. The raw permutation test is exact at $\gamma = 0$ (0.048), but its size moves with γ , reaching 0.064 at $\gamma = 30$.

```
def size_study(gamma, reps, B, seed, n=12, alpha=0.05):
    """Rejection rates at level alpha when beta = 0 and the nuisance coefficient is
    gamma."""
    rng = np.random.default_rng(seed)
    z = np.linspace(-1, 1, n)
    x = 0.8 * z + 0.6 * np.random.default_rng(1).normal(size=n) # fixed,
    correlated with z
    x[0] = 6.0 # one high-leverage value of x
    Z = np.column_stack([np.ones(n), z])
    rejections = {}
    for _ in range(reps):
        y = 1.0 + gamma * z + rng.normal(size=n) # the null hypothesis beta = 0
        holds
        for m, pv in perm_pvalues(y, x, Z, B, rng)[0].items():
            rejections[m] = rejections.get(m, 0) + (pv <= alpha)
    return {m: r / reps for m, r in rejections.items()}

for gamma in (0.0, 30.0):
    print(gamma, size_study(gamma, reps=300, B=99, seed=2308))
```

[Run this code online](#)

As Anderson and Legendre (1999) concluded from a much larger simulation, Freedman–Lane is the sensible default: exact whenever an exact test exists, blind to the nuisance coefficients, and close to the oracle in large samples. ter Braak’s scheme behaves similarly, and since its reference distribution does not need the null hypothesis, it suits the inversion of tests into intervals. Winkler and coauthors (2014) review the schemes for the general linear model.

23.5.4 Exercises

23.5.4.1 A. Check your understanding

Exercise. A1

Show that when $\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{1}$ the Freedman–Lane, Kennedy and raw permutation tests all coincide with the permutation test of [Section 23.4](#).

Solution. With $\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{1}$, every permutation fixes $\mathbf{Z}$, so by [Proposition 23.5.1\(c\)](#) Freedman–Lane and the raw permutation coincide and are exact. Kennedy’s scheme differs only through $\|\mathbf{M}_0 \mathbf{P} \hat{\boldsymbol{\epsilon}}_0\|^2 = n \overline{(\mathbf{P} \hat{\boldsymbol{\epsilon}}_0)^2}$, which is zero because $\hat{\boldsymbol{\epsilon}}_0 = \mathbf{y} - \bar{y} \mathbf{1}$ sums to zero and permuting does not change the sum.

Exercise. A2

In ter Braak’s scheme, what is the permuted statistic for $\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{I}$? Explain why the observed statistic must still be counted in the numerator and denominator of [Eq. 23.4.1](#).

23.5.4.2 B. Practice

Exercise. B1

Let $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ be fixed and $\mathbf{P}$ a uniformly random permutation matrix. Show that $E(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}) = \bar{v} \mathbf{1}$ and $\text{Cov}(\mathbf{P}\mathbf{v}) = \frac{S_v}{n-1} (\mathbf{I} - n^{-1} \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top)$ with $S_v = \sum_i (v_i - \bar{v})^2$. (The computation is the one in the proof of [Proposition 18.4.2](#), there for permutations within a block.)

23.5.4.3 C. Going deeper

Exercise. C1

Suppose the errors are independent with variances that depend on $\mathbf{X}_1$. Explain why the schemes of [Definition 23.5.1](#) need not be asymptotically valid for $H_0 : \boldsymbol{\beta}_1 = \mathbf{0}$, and where the argument of [Proposition 23.5.1\(d\)](#) breaks down. Propose a studentized version in the spirit of [Section 23.4](#).